

ABC Technologies – Workplace and Information Security Policy

Document Information

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Applies To: All employees, contractors, and interns with access to company systems

1. Purpose

This policy sets out the rules for working from home, protecting company information, using company devices, and handling security incidents. Its goal is to protect company data, client trust, and employee safety. All employees must follow this policy at all times.

2. Work From Home Policy

Employees may work from home on a regular or occasional basis, subject to manager approval. Eligible employees may work from home up to 2 days per week. Work from home requests must be submitted through the HR Portal, and the reporting manager approves or rejects them. Approval is based on the employee's role, performance, and team needs. Employees may not work from home during their probation period unless the manager approves an exception in writing.

3. Remote Work Requirements

Employees working from home must have a stable broadband connection and a private, quiet workspace. All remote work must be done through the company VPN. Employees must remain reachable during working hours, which are 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM on working days, and must respond to urgent messages within 30 minutes. Employees must keep their work devices in a secure location and must not allow family members or visitors to use them.

4. Information Security

Every employee is responsible for protecting company information and systems. Employees must follow the rules in this policy, complete required security training, and report any suspicious activity. Security controls, such as antivirus software, device encryption, and access restrictions, must not be disabled or bypassed.

5. Password Security

Passwords must be at least 12 characters long and must include uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and symbols. Passwords must be changed every 90 days and cannot reuse any of the last 5 passwords. Passwords must never be shared with anyone, including IT staff. Employees should use the approved company password manager to store their passwords. Passwords must not be written on paper, stored in plain text files, or sent by email.

6. Multi-Factor Authentication

Multi-factor authentication must be enabled on all company accounts where it is available. This includes company email, the VPN, cloud storage, and business applications. Employees must not approve login requests they did not start. If an employee receives an unexpected login approval request, they must reject it and report it to the IT Service Desk immediately.

7. Company Laptop Security

Company laptops must be locked whenever they are left unattended, even for a short time. Screens must lock automatically after 5 minutes of inactivity. Laptop hard drives must be encrypted. Employees must not connect personal USB drives to company laptops. Company laptops must be kept with the employee at all times when traveling.

8. Internet and Email Usage

Company email must be used for all business communication. Employees must not send company information to personal email accounts. Internet access on company devices must be used for work-related purposes. Access to websites that contain illegal, pornographic, or malicious content is prohibited. Employees must not download files from untrusted sources.

9. Software Installation

Employees may install only software that has been approved by the IT department. To request new software, employees submit a request through the IT portal. The IT team reviews requests within 3 working days. Employees must not install unlicensed or pirated software on company devices. Personal software may not be installed on company laptops without approval.

10. Data Protection

Company information is classified into four levels: Public, Internal, Confidential, and Restricted. Confidential and Restricted information must be stored only in approved company systems and must be encrypted during transfer. Employees must not copy client data to personal devices or external storage. Data must be deleted securely when it is no longer needed.

11. Confidential Information

Employees must not share confidential information with anyone outside the company without written approval from their manager and the Information Security team. Confidential information includes client data, source code, system credentials, financial data, and employee records. This obligation applies during and after employment.

12. Phishing and Suspicious Emails

Phishing emails attempt to trick employees into revealing passwords, clicking malicious links, or opening harmful attachments. If an employee receives a suspicious email, they must not click any links or open any attachments. The employee should report the email using the Report Phishing button in the email client or by forwarding it to the IT Service Desk. Reporting must happen immediately upon receiving the suspicious email.

13. Reporting Security Incidents

A security incident includes lost or stolen devices, suspected account compromise, accidental data disclosure, malware infection, and unauthorized access. All security incidents must be reported to the IT Service Desk within 2 hours of discovery. The report must include the date, time, and a short description of what happened. Employees must not try to investigate or fix the incident on their own.

14. Remote Meeting Etiquette

Employees must join scheduled meetings on time. Microphones should be muted when not speaking. Cameras should be turned on for client meetings and team review sessions unless the meeting organizer allows otherwise. Employees should use a professional background and must not share confidential screens without checking that other participants are authorized to view them.

15. Expense Reimbursement

Employees may claim reimbursement for approved business expenses, such as travel, client meals, and software subscriptions approved in advance. Expenses must be submitted within 30 days of the date of purchase through the expense portal. Valid itemized receipts are required for every claim. Claims are approved by the reporting manager and are paid in the payroll cycle following approval. Claims submitted after 30 days are not accepted unless HR approves an exception.

16. Conflict of Interest

Employees must disclose any personal financial interest, family relationship, or outside business that could affect their decisions at work. Disclosures must be made in writing to the reporting manager and HR within 5 working days of becoming aware of the conflict. Employees must not accept gifts or payments from clients or vendors above INR 2,000 in value.

17. Social Media Guidelines

Employees may use social media in a personal capacity, but they must not share confidential information, client names, project details, or internal documents. Employees must make it clear that their personal opinions do not represent the company. Employees must not post content that could harm the reputation of the company or its colleagues.

18. Dress Code

Employees must follow the dress code described in the Employee Handbook. Professional attire is required for client meetings, including video calls with client representatives.

19. Policy Violations

Violations of this policy are handled under the disciplinary process described in the Employee Handbook. Serious violations, such as deliberate data theft, sharing confidential information with competitors, or bypassing security controls, may result in immediate termination and legal action. Employees who accidentally violate the policy must report the issue immediately so it can be corrected quickly.

20. Contacting IT and HR

Employees can contact the IT Service Desk through the IT portal or by calling internal extension 4200. Security incidents must be reported to the IT Service Desk as described in this policy. Questions about work from home, expenses, or conflicts of interest can be directed to the HR Helpdesk at internal extension 4100.